LIS470: Interaction Design

Studio: Contextual Inquiry

Today’s studio

Goal: Prepare groups to conduct contextual inquiries by developing, piloting, and revising their inquiry guides.

Agenda

0 - 15m: **Create** contextual inquiry guide

15 - 50m: **Test** guide on other team

50 - 55m: **Debrief** contextual inquiry

55 - 75m: **Group-work** time

Friday lecture recap

Why is data collection important?

your insights determine the quality of your solution.

Why does *how* you collect it matter?

different methods give different types of insight.

Behavioral vs Attitudinal

What people do
What people say

Big Data limitations

Surveys = what people report
Log files = what people do
But **neither gives context or "why"**

method shapes insight.

Contextual inquiries

Why choose a contextual inquiry?

when you need to understand behavior

Behavioral Data (What they do)

Task steps and sequences
Strategies and shortcuts
Workarounds
Breakdowns
Role dynamics

Contextual Data

Physical environment
Social influences
Interruptions
Tools and artifacts
Time pressures

Motivational Data (Why they do it)

Intentions
Decision criteria
Frustrations
Values
Tradeoffs

Contextual inquiries

Why is it important to prepare for a CI?

quality of data collection --> quality of insights --> quality of your solution

What types of things are usually **good to map out?**

- **Activity that you're studying? (be specific as possible)**
- **Context (what are you hoping to understand?)**
- **Needs they have?**
- **Values of the user?**

Studio today

Mock contextual inquiries!

with your team...

1. Select an activity
2. Plan a contextual inquiry guide
3. Test it with 2 other teams

Select an activity for research participants to perform e.g., booking a ticket, planning a vacation, creating an invite for an event, etc. The task should be specific:

Plan a trip for you and your friend from Madison to Cancun for under $300 for the dates March 12 - 23. E-mail the itinerary to yourself and your friend.

Choose your favorite hobby and create a playlist of ten YouTube videos that would teach a novice about the topic.

Studio today

Download the inquiry guide and in collaboration with your table group members you should write a description of the:

Activity: Description of the activity and your motivation for researching the activity

Focus Objectives: While you can observe everything, your group should consider what are the most important aspects of the activity to observe/record e.g., emotional responses, choice rationales

Follow-up questions: Additional questions to ask at the end to the interview. “How does this experience compare to [X product/company]?” or “I noticed during [the activity] you [performed some interesting activity]. Can you explain your decision?

Testing

Using the guide your group created, your group will conduct **two contextual inquiries** with a member from another group.

- One group member will act as a participant in another groups study
- One group member will focus on interacting with the participant
- The remaining group member(s) will take notes and observe the study

During the second run each group member should adopt a new role.

Testing

Build rapport: Introduce yourself and explain why are you conducting the inquiry.

> *Engaging in small talk is important for making the participant comfortable. “How was your trip here?”*

Thinking aloud: A core aspect of the CI is accessing participants’ **internal thinking** processes. Encourage participants to think aloud as they perform tasks and make decisions.

> *Prompt them with “What’s going on here?” or “What happened there?”*

Testing

What should the facilitator observe and record? You should bring a note book and your inquiry guide. Focus on recording activities in the focus objective. You should also pay attention to:

Details – adding granularity and specificity to an observation can make it much more meaningful

The activity ecosystem – Ensure you're examining activities in their whole; look at context of activity/product use. Isis used in conjunction with their device? Where does the activity exist in the flow daily lives?

Debrief

Group (4 minutes) – What went well, what did not, how might they have improved the guide.

Class (2 minutes)

tips for planning questions

“A Cheatsheet for User Interview and Follow Ups Questions”

“User Interview Example Questions”

“Writing an Effective Guide for a UX Interview”

Conducting contextual inquires

Activity: Description of the activity and your motivation for researching the activity

Observer name: Researcher name

Participant name: Participant name

Description of the method: What you did.

Observations: Your notes from the observation. Bullet points are fine. Take photos.

Follow-up questions: Additional questions to ask at the end to the interview.“How does this experience compare to [X product/company]?” or “I noticed you used [X tool]. Tell me why you did that?”

Conducting contextual inquires – tips!

Build rapport: Introduce yourself and explain why are you doing the research. Engaging in small talk is important for making the participant comfortable.

Get participant talking: A core aspect of the CI is accessing their cognition process. Participants should be thinking aloud as they perform the activity. Prompt them with "What's going on here" or "What happened there" if they go silent

- Ask about concrete experiences
- Avoid yes-no questions
- Avoid "Would you use", and "What feature do you want" questions
- Take notes on paper
- ***Separate observations from interpretation***

Top Hat! :)

Announcements

design di. interactive

+ workshops
+ speakers
+ site visits
+ semester-long design (ux) projects

Spring Kickoff Meeting

Tuesday, Feb 17th, 6-7 PM

RM 2516, Morgridge Hall

Announcements

UX Club!

THINK FIRST, DESIGN SECOND

SP26 x UX CLUB

2556 Morgridge Hall
2nd Floor, Student Org Room

Thursday, February 19th

6:00 PM - 7:00 PM

- Learn UX research fundamentals
- Understand the full design process

OVERVIEW

Kick off our first workshop, Think First, Design Second, where we'll dive into UX research for a real company and lay the foundation for a website redesign project.